

Exploring the Role of Agnihotra in Enhancing Life Satisfaction for Spiritual Harmony and Well-Being

Shrikant Kallurkar^{1,a)}, Anand Prakash², and Jagruti Bhatia³

¹ Advisor Research, Institute of Studies in Vedic Sciences, Shivpuri, Akkalkot, Dist- Solapur, Maharashtra, 413216, India

² School of Project Management, NICMAR University, Pune, India

³ Coordinator Research, Institute of Studies in Vedic Sciences, Shivpuri, Akkalkot, Dist- Solapur, Maharashtra, 413216

a) Corresponding author: drkallurkar@yahoo.co.in

b) ms.jagruti.bhatia@gmail.com

ABSTRACT

Agnihotra, an old Vedic practice, has drawn interest because of the massive role it plays in combating pollution in all forms from Air, Water, Soil and more importantly from today's perspective Thought pollution or Mental Health and well-being. The transformative effects of Agnihotra have been documented in numerous scientific studies, personal experiences and testimonials around the world. It is a healing tool which anyone can utilize regardless of race, creed or religion.

This study explores the connection between Agnihotra and life satisfaction, a vital element of human thriving. It contextualizes the historical origins, ritualistic elements, and cultural settings of the practice of Agnihotra through a comprehensive review of literature. Using empirical research, the study explores how Agnihotra might improve life satisfaction. The 5-item scale of Diener et al. (1985) is used to measure the global cognitive judgments of one's life satisfaction with items of fulfilled, superb, content, successful, and fulgent. Participants indicate how much they agree or disagree with each of the 5 items using a 7-point scale that ranges from '7' meaning 'strongly agree' to '1' meaning 'strongly disagree'. The study reports that there is no significant difference in life satisfaction scores with Agnihotra for different and independent financial strata groups, namely, as below 35 years, 35 - 45 years, 45-60 years, and above 60 years. Moreover, the results of linear regression provide the coefficient of determination as 100% showing the linear relationships among variables, namely, fulfilled, superb, content, successful, and fulgent. The study draws implications of Agnihotra for encompassing its potential therapeutic applications and integration with contemporary wellness practices. This paper contributes to the discourse by giving insight into enhanced life satisfaction with Agnihotra, and fostering comprehensive human flourishing for spiritual harmony and well-being.

Keywords: Agnihotra; Life satisfaction; Well-being; Vedic practice; Ancient philosophies; Human prosperity

1. INTRODUCTION

Agnihotra is a centuries-old Vedic fire ritual that has been carried out in India. A scientifically proven simple process of burning fire using dried cow-dung cakes and offering uncooked, cow ghee smeared rice grains, to the fire at the precise time of sunrise and sunset, with the chanting of two simple mantras in a pyramid-shaped copper vessel. Agnihotra is a tradition that has its roots in Vedic scriptures from the Rigveda, Yajurveda, Atharvaveda and even subtle mentions across the Buddhist literatures, Bible and Koran. The transformative effects of Agnihotra have been documented in numerous scientific studies, personal experiences and testimonials around the world. It is a healing tool which anyone can utilize regardless of race, creed or religion. The whole process takes not more than five to ten minutes during morning and evening. Agnihotra is highly revered on a cultural and spiritual level, and its usefulness in resolving environmental and health issues is still being debated and researched. Although several studies have looked at its possible effects on air [4, 5] and water quality [6, 7], more thorough scientific research is required to determine its effectiveness in these areas.

Life satisfaction is a fundamental concept in psychology and social sciences, sometimes known as subjective well-being or happiness. It reflects an overall assessment of an individual of their life, considering both their cognitive assessments and emotional experiences. It goes beyond objective indicators like income, education, and health to capture the individual's perception of their well-being. Researchers attempt to understand the big picture of life satisfaction for several reasons, which include psychological well-being, health and longevity, social and economic outcomes, policy and governance, and positive psychology. Comparing life satisfaction across cultures and countries can provide important insights into the differences in

cultural values, norms, and priorities. It aids in the understanding of how socioeconomic and cultural issues impact well-being by researchers and policymakers.

This study intends to have a specific research focus on investigating whether the traditional Vedic fire ritual, Agnihotra, has any potential impact on an individual's life satisfaction. The purpose of this research paper is to investigate empirically a traditional cultural and spiritual practice (Agnihotra) on life satisfaction. This requires exploring the ritual's elements, procedures, and underlying assumptions to see how it could affect individuals' overall well-being by conducting surveys to gather data on the life satisfaction levels of individuals who practice Agnihotra. By looking at Agnihotra in the context of life satisfaction, this study seeks to contribute to the body of knowledge on traditional practices, psychology, and well-being. It may help in bridging the knowledge gap between contemporary scientific understanding, and cultural and spiritual traditions.

2. PREVIOUS LITERATURE REVIEWS

The Indian traditional medical system known as Ayurveda is frequently linked with Agnihotra to balance the three doshas (Vata, Pitta, and Kapha) in the body, leading to better health [2]. Agnihotra resuscitated from the ashrams of Shivratri, Akkalkot, Maharashtra, India is performed across borders by practitioners as a process to heal the atmosphere and this helps them to gain more mindfulness, develop an attitude of servitude, which helps them purify themselves spiritually and advance their spiritual growth and inner tranquillity [3]. It is regarded as a means of establishing a spiritual connection and synchronizing one's life with cosmic rhythms. It is frequently viewed as a method to invoke blessings and gratitude to 'Prajapati' which is the Lord of creation / the Universe itself. Agnihotra is highly revered on a cultural and spiritual level, yet its usefulness in resolving environmental and health issues is still being debated and researched. Although several studies have looked at its possible effects on air [4, 5] and water quality [6, 7], more thorough scientific research is required to determine its effectiveness in these areas.

2.1. Agnihotra: An Ancient Vedic Practice

Agnihotra origins may be traced to the Vedas, the earliest holy books known to mankind, which are said to have been written between 1500 and 1200 BC [10]. The Yajur Veda, one of the four Vedas, contains a particular reference to Agnihotra in a portion known as the "Shukla Yajur Veda" and the "Krishna Yajur Veda" [11]. The Agnihotra ritual is described in great detail in these scriptures.

The first verse of the Rig Veda itself translates as:

Rigveda 1.1: I glorify Agni, the high priest of the sacrifice, the divine, the ministrant, who presents the oblation (to the gods), and is the possessor of great wealth.

Some other references from the Vedas:

- Rigveda 10.118.1: "Agnihotra, the first born of rites, he offered, the householder, the giver of wealth."
- Yajurveda 3.62: "Let the householder make the Agnihotra offering, as ordained, at sunrise and sunset."

2.2. Explanation of Agnihotra ritual

The Sanskrit words "Agni" (fire) and "Hotra" (offering or sacrifice) are combined to get the term "Agnihotra". As a result, Agnihotra might be interpreted as a "fire offering" or "fire sacrifice". Agnihotra was historically one of the everyday rites carried out by Vedic priests and common people in ancient India. In the Vedic civilization, it was seen as a necessary practice. Agni, the deity of fire, was worshipped as part of the ceremony, which was thought to have several spiritual, agricultural, and environmental advantages.

Agnihotra is a ritual that has a strong connection to the daily biorhythmic cycle of sunrise and sunset [12]. It is performed at the precise local biological time of sunrise and sunset. These timings are essential because they are the Transitional time of the phases of change from night to day and from day to night. These times are known as "Sandhya" in Sanskrit, which denotes the junction or meeting place. There are two types of agnihotra – Morning Agnihotra (Pratah Agnihotra) and Evening Agnihotra (Sayam Agnihotra). Depending on the location and time of year, the morning Agnihotra is performed at the precise moment of sunrise. Calculating the exact moment, the sun's disc first appears on the horizon is crucial as during this exact time the sun's rays are tangential to the earth and this is said to release a lot of bioenergy which helps cleanse both the surroundings and mentality. Likewise, the evening Agnihotra ritual is carried out at the exact time of local sunset. As the day gives way to night at sunset, practicing Agnihotra at this time helps in harnessing the abundant energy through the agency of fire via the specifically designed and dimensioned shape of the copper pyramid and released manifold into the atmosphere. This is believed to provide harmony and balance to all of nature including the performer. Agnihotra is a very precise rite which also has a profound spiritual significance. Its procedure is as follows:

- Preparation: Agnihotra preparation involves making sure the Agnihotra pyramid is clean and pure before beginning the procedure. The cow dung cakes and unbroken raw rice grains soaked in cow's (or its progeny) ghee (clarified butter) are made in preparation.
- Timing: Agnihotra must be started precisely at the time of local sunrise and local sunset, as was previously specified.
- Lighting the Fire: Fire is initiated by igniting the cow-dung cakes smeared with the cow's ghee within the pyramid. After starting the fire, the practitioner adds ghee to get the fire to a full blaze until the exact time of Sunrise / Sunset as applicable.
- Offerings: At this precise time there are two offerings / oblations of uncooked unbroken rice grains smeared in cow's ghee; one after recitation of each Mantra (Manas – means Mind and 'tra' means instrument – Mantra essentially functions as a 'Tool of the Mind'); are offered into the fire as oblations during the rite.
- Silent Meditation: After the oblations and mantras are finished, a period of silent meditation or prayer is observed, with the focus being on the sense of mindfulness and gratitude which leads to a spiritual connection.

The Vedic literature, particularly the Yajur Veda, exhaustively outlines the ingredients and steps for performing Agnihotra. The main ingredients are as follows:

- Agnihotra Pyramid: To contain the fire, a small pyramid-shaped structure which is 14.5 cms X 14.5 cms at the top, tapering down on 3 steps to 5.25 cms X 5.25 cms with a height of 6.5 composed of copper, gold or specific mud /clay as mentioned in the literature. The purpose of this sacred pyramid is to be able to harness the energy from its surrounding pushing it to its centre and keep the fire in its optimal form and temperature.
- Cow Dung: Cow dung cakes are made by drying out the cow dung (cow or its progeny), which is thought to have cleansing characteristics, to make the little cakes known as "Agnihotra fuel". These cakes, put within the pyramid, are crucial for keeping the fire going.
- Ghee (Clarified Butter): The principal fuel for the Agnihotra fire is ghee, which is poured over the cakes inside the pyramid to keep the fire ablaze during the oblations.
- Rice: Uncooked (preferably unpolished / brown) rice grains smeared with cows ghee are offered into the flames, while reciting Vedic mantras, as mentioned above.
- Mantras: An essential component of Agnihotra is the recital of particular Vedic mantras. These mantras are said precisely and fervently.
- Keep an eye on your watch / Agnihotra app watch and at the exact local sunrise time, start uttering first Mantra, - "Sooryaya Svaha. On the utterance of the word Svaha offer one part of the rice grains to the fire and continuing the Mantra complete the first line uttering "Sooryaya Idam Na Mama".
- Uttering the other line of the Mantra offer other part of the rice grains to the fire after saying "Prajapataye Svaha". Again at the utterance of the word Svaha offer the remaining second part of the offering in the Fire and complete the Mantra uttering "Prajapataye Idam Na Mama".
- The morning Agnihotra is concluded here
- You may try and concentrate / meditate on the fire till the offerings are fully burnt. Try and focus on the movements of the Fire.
- You can do your regular spiritual practice or practice other Vedic Sciences like Yoga, Meditation, etc. after the performance of Agnihotra. After the Fire is completely burnt out, place the Agnihotra pot in a clean and hygienic place. If you are in a rush and cannot wait till the Fire is completely burnt out, then, make sure to place the pot with the fire still alive on a height or a platform to avoid any injuries. This care has to be taken especially when there are children in the house. The morning Agnihotra concludes here.

- In the evening before the Agnihotra time remove very carefully the morning Agnihotra ash from the vessel and put it in a bag or box specially kept aside for it. Repeating the morning process prepare a fresh fire from the cow dung cakes in the vessel. Also prepare two equal parts of the cow ghee smeared raw whole rice grains for the two offerings.
- Exactly at sunset time, accompanied by the chanting of sunset Agnihotra Mantras – “Agnaye Svaha” offer the first part after saying Svaha and complete the Mantra by saying “Agnaye Idam Na Mama”. Similarly, uttering the second line of the Mantra offer other part of the rice grains to the fire after saying “Prajapataye Svaha” and complete the Mantra uttering “Prajapataye Idam Na Mama”. Concentrate on the fire till the offerings are fully burnt.
- This concludes the evening Agnihotra

2.3. Understanding Life Satisfaction

Life satisfaction is a complex and multifaceted concept that encompasses an individual's feelings, attitudes, and perceptions about life as a whole [13]. Life satisfaction is often used as a key indicator of an individual's well-being and quality of life [14]. A person's entire level of mental and emotional health is referred to as their emotional well-being. This includes their capacity to manage stress, feel happy, be resilient in the face of difficulties, and cultivate healthy relationships.

The emotional or affective component and the judging or cognitive component have been conceptualized as the two main parts of the structure of subjective well-being [1, 15]. Earlier, Andrews and Withey (1976) [16] had conceptualized the judgmental component as life satisfaction. Over the years, the judgemental component of subjective well-being has gotten very little attention from academics, regardless of the emotional component receiving a lot of attention. To fill this gap in the literature, Diener et al. (1985) [1] developed “The Satisfaction with Life Scale (SWLS)” as a measure of the judgmental component of subjective well-being, which was subsequently validated by independent studies. The external criteria used for the validation of SWLS were peer reports, a memory measure, and clinical ratings. Since Diener et al. (1985), much evidence for the reliability and predictive validity of the SWLS was presented, and its performance was compared to other related scales.

In comparison to many other measures of life satisfaction, the SWLS has been demonstrated to be a valid and reliable indicator of life satisfaction that is appropriate for use with a wide variety of age groups and applications [17]. Additionally, there is considerable evidence that subjective well-being is a generally widespread and persistent phenomenon rather than merely a temporary judgment based on transient effects according to the high convergence of self- and peer-reported measures of life satisfaction.

2.4. Critical Appraisal on the Role of Agnihotra in Enhancing Life Satisfaction

The current body of scientific research mostly ignores the effect of Agnihotra in raising life satisfaction. A considerable study gap exists when it comes to precisely evaluating the effect of Agnihotra on life satisfaction, although there is some research on the general issue of traditional rituals, spirituality, and well-being. Some causes of this gap can be attributed to limited research funding, cultural and geographic specificity, and limited awareness about the role of Agnihotra in enhancing life satisfaction.

3. METHODOLOGY

Here's a step-by-step approach to researching the role of Agnihotra in enhancing life satisfaction using a survey questionnaire.

- Step 1: Define Research Objectives and Hypotheses – This study intends to explore and determine the specific aspects of life satisfaction concerning Agnihotra. Additionally, this study tests hypotheses that outline the expected findings based on the existing literature.
- Step 2: Design the Survey Questionnaire – This study develops a questionnaire that seeks to collect both classification and interval-scaled statements related to Agnihotra and life satisfaction. The study has ensured that questionnaire items are clear, unbiased, and easy to understand. The study has included demographic questions for the classification of respondents based on gender, age, marital status, number of members in the family, financial strata, performing Agnihotra, and years since performing Agnihotra to characterize the sample of Hindus. The study used a 7-point Likert scale (ranging from 1 to 7) for interval-scaled 5 statements to measure respondents'

perceptions and attitudes. Although the scoring was kept continuous such that the scoring sums up scores on each item of the interval scale with cut-off benchmarks used as extremely satisfied for 31 – 35, satisfied for 26 – 30, slightly satisfied for 21 – 25, neutral for 20, slightly dissatisfied for 15 – 19, dissatisfied for 10 – 14, and extremely dissatisfied for 5 – 9. Respondents were also told to give their overall opinion on the performance of Agnihotra that has an effect on their life regarding the 5 statements using the interval scale. These five statements of the SWLS were “In most ways, my life is close to my ideal” coded as “Fulfilled”, “The conditions of my life are excellent” coded as “Superb”, “I am satisfied with my life” coded as “Content”, “So far I have gotten the important things I want in life” coded as “Successful”, and “If I could live my life over, I would change almost nothing” coded as “Fulgent”.

- Step 3: Pre-test the Questionnaire – The questionnaire was made to undergo a pilot test with a small group of respondents, which happened to be 10 individuals, to identify any issues with question-wording, comprehension, or response options for making appropriate and duly required revisions.
- Step 4: Sampling Technique – The target demographics were specified to be respondents who have been practitioners of Agnihotra. The study has not included such who have not been aware of the practice of Agnihotra. Further, the study included 12 respondents who were aware of the practice of Agnihotra but have not been its practitioners keeping the sample size limited to 100 who were aware of the practice of Agnihotra. The study used the convenience sampling method making sure that the sample is varied and representative.
- Step 5: Data Collection – The data for this study was collected using an online filling of Google Forms with assurance to respondents that their responses would be kept anonymous and confidential while publishing the results in journals and conferences of repute.
- Step 6: Data Analysis – The usable data were to be analyzed using statistical software like SPSS to report summary statistics like means, frequencies, and percentages to analyze descriptive data. Further, for the analysis of interval data, suitable statistical techniques like t-tests, ANOVA, regression analysis, or correlation analysis can be applied. This analysis of data can be followed by interpreting the statistical findings and discussing the implications of these findings and how they connect to previous research, paying particular attention to the impact of Agnihotra on life satisfaction.

The study examines how Agnihotra improves life happiness by using this methodical research approach to make significant contributions to the fields of spirituality and well-being.

4. DATA ANALYSIS

Based on a sample of 100 respondents, Table 1 provides descriptive statistics for several classification variables like the distribution of age, the distribution of the number of family members, and the distribution of the number of years individuals have been performing Agnihotra. In addition, Table 1 also provides descriptive statistics describing scaled variables named “Fulfilled”, “Superb”, “Content”, “Successful”, and “Fulgent” of the SWLS.

There are 66 male respondents coded as ‘1’ and the remaining are female respondents coded as ‘2’ in Table 1. The mean age of the respondents in Table 1 is 47.39 years, indicating their average age. The standard deviation value of 14.4 years gives a measure of the amount of variation or dispersion in the ages. The standard error is also provided, which is useful for estimating the precision of the mean. The variance value of 207.43 is another measure of the spread of the age values. There are 12 unmarried respondents coded as ‘1’ and the remaining are married respondents coded as ‘2’ in Table 1. The average number of family members in the sample respondents is 4.71 with the value for standard deviation as 1.86567 and the value for variance as 3.481. The distribution of the number of years respondents have been performing Agnihotra has a mean of 17.06 years with the values of standard deviation as 1.51836 and variance of 230.542. There are 12 respondents of lower middle class coded as ‘1’, 66 of them from the middle class coded as ‘2’, 20 of them from the higher middle class coded as ‘3’ and the remaining are the rich class respondents coded as ‘4’ in Table 1. The mean for “Fulfilled” is 5.91 with the values for standard deviation as 0.12235 and variance as 1.497. The mean for “Superb” is 5.90 with the values for standard deviation as 0.17764 and variance as 1.384. The mean for “Content” is 6.12 with the values for standard deviation as 0.12084 and variance as 1.460. The mean for “Successful” is 5.76 with the values for standard deviation as 0.13935 and variance as 1.942. The mean for “Fulgent” is 5.17 with the values for standard deviation as 0.15443 and variance as 2.385.

Table 1 Descriptive Statistics.

	N	Mean		Std. Deviation	Variance
	Statistic	Statistic	Std. Error	Statistic	Statistic
Gender	100	1.3400	0.04761	0.47610	0.227

Age	100	47.3900	1.44025	14.40251	207.432
Marital Status	100	1.880	0.03266	0.32660	0.107
Family Members	100	4.7100	.18657	1.86567	3.481
Years Performing Agnihotra	100	17.0600	1.51836	15.18360	230.542
Financial Strata	100	2.1200	0.06241	0.62410	0.389
Fulfilled	100	5.9100	.12235	1.22347	1.497
Superb	100	5.9000	.11764	1.17637	1.384
Content	100	6.1200	.12084	1.20839	1.460
Successful	100	5.7600	.13935	1.39349	1.942
Fulgent	100	5.1700	.15443	1.54433	2.385
Valid N (listwise)	100				

On an overall basis, respondents have rated different variables of the SWLS quite highly in Table 1. The low values of standard deviation for the different variables of the SWLS suggest that there is not much variability in the responses, and the majority of respondents gave similar ratings. The variance is another measure of how spread out the values are, which suggests that the ratings for the different variables of the SWLS are relatively tightly clustered around their respective mean. It is to be noticed that the variable “Content” has a mean of 6.12, indicating a slightly higher average rating compared to the remaining other variables of the SWLS. The low standard deviations for most variables suggest that responses are generally consistent.

Table 2 One-way ANOVA with respect to Financial Strata.

		Sum of Squares	df	Mean Square	F	Sig.
Fulfilled	Between Groups	3.307	3	1.102	.730	.536
	Within Groups	144.883	96	1.509		
	Total	148.190	99			
Superb	Between Groups	2.917	3	.972	.696	.557
	Within Groups	134.083	96	1.397		
	Total	137.000	99			
Content	Between Groups	1.639	3	.546	.367	.777
	Within Groups	142.921	96	1.489		
	Total	144.560	99			
Successful	Between Groups	9.010	3	3.003	1.573	.201
	Within Groups	183.230	96	1.909		
	Total	192.240	99			
Fulgent	Between Groups	9.580	3	3.193	1.353	.262
	Within Groups	226.530	96	2.360		
	Total	236.110	99			

In all cases of different variables of the SWLS shown in Table 2, the p-values are greater than 0.05, suggesting that there is no significant difference in the scores between the financial strata groups for these variables. Therefore, there is no sufficient evidence to reject the null hypothesis that the means are equal.

Table 3 Multiple Comparisons of One-way ANOVA using Tukey HSD with respect to Financial Strata.

Dependent Variable	(I) Financial_Strata	(J) Financial_Strata	Mean Difference (I-J)	Std. Error	Sig.
Fulfilled	Lower Middle	Middle	.50000	.38553	.567
		Higher Middle	.48333	.44858	.704
		Rich Class	-.16667	.93828	.998
	Middle	Lower Middle	-.50000	.38553	.567
		Higher Middle	-.01667	.31357	1.000
		Rich Class	-.66667	.88174	.874
	Higher Middle	Lower Middle	-.48333	.44858	.704
		Middle	.01667	.31357	1.000
		Rich Class	-.65000	.91108	.892
	Rich Class	Lower Middle	.16667	.93828	.998
		Middle	.66667	.88174	.874
		Higher Middle	.65000	.91108	.892
Superb	Lower Middle	Middle	.08333	.37088	.996
		Higher Middle	-.08333	.43154	.997
		Rich Class	-1.08333	.90263	.628
	Middle	Lower Middle	-.08333	.37088	.996
		Higher Middle	-.16667	.30166	.946
		Rich Class	-1.16667	.84824	.518
	Higher Middle	Lower Middle	.08333	.43154	.997
		Middle	.16667	.30166	.946
		Rich Class	-1.00000	.87646	.665
	Rich Class	Lower Middle	1.08333	.90263	.628
		Middle	1.16667	.84824	.518
		Higher Middle	1.00000	.87646	.665
Content	Lower Middle	Middle	.07576	.38291	.997
		Higher Middle	.06667	.44554	.999
		Rich Class	-.83333	.93190	.808
	Middle	Lower Middle	-.07576	.38291	.997
		Higher Middle	-.00909	.31144	1.000
		Rich Class	-.90909	.87575	.728
	Higher Middle	Lower Middle	-.06667	.44554	.999
		Middle	.00909	.31144	1.000
		Rich Class	-.90000	.90489	.753
	Rich Class	Lower Middle	.83333	.93190	.808
		Middle	.90909	.87575	.728
		Higher Middle	.90000	.90489	.753
Successful	Lower Middle	Middle	.62121	.43356	.482
		Higher Middle	-.03333	.50447	1.000

	Middle	Rich Class	.16667	1.05517	.999
		Lower Middle	-.62121	.43356	.482
		Higher Middle	-.65455	.35263	.254
		Rich Class	-.45455	.99159	.968
	Higher Middle	Lower Middle	.03333	.50447	1.000
		Middle	.65455	.35263	.254
		Rich Class	.20000	1.02458	.997
	Rich Class	Lower Middle	-.16667	1.05517	.999
		Middle	.45455	.99159	.968
		Higher Middle	-.20000	1.02458	.997
Fulgent	Lower Middle	Middle	.71212	.48207	.455
		Higher Middle	.16667	.56091	.991
		Rich Class	-.33333	1.17324	.992
	Middle	Lower Middle	-.71212	.48207	.455
		Higher Middle	-.54545	.39209	.508
		Rich Class	-1.04545	1.10254	.779
	Higher Middle	Lower Middle	-.16667	.56091	.991
		Middle	.54545	.39209	.508
		Rich Class	-.50000	1.13922	.972
	Rich Class	Lower Middle	.33333	1.17324	.992
		Middle	1.04545	1.10254	.779
		Higher Middle	.50000	1.13922	.972

In Table 3, for all five dependent variables, namely, “Fulfilled”, “Superb”, “Content”, “Successful”, and “Fulgent”; the Tukey HSD test did not find any significant differences between the financial strata groups. The p-values for all pairwise comparisons are greater than the typical significance level of 0.05, suggesting that the means of these groups are not significantly different for the specified variables. With the available data, a test for significant differences among three or more independent groups can only be computed with respect to data of financial strata.

Similar calculations have been tried out with respect to age groups as “below 35 years”, “35 - 45 years”, “45-60 years”, and “above 60 years”, however, the results of ANOVA could not be obtained or might be unreliable as the result of ANOVA relies on certain assumptions, such as normality of residuals and homogeneity of variances.

Table 4 Model Summary.

Model	R	R Square	Adjusted R Square	Std. Error of the Estimate
1	1.000 ^a	1.000	1.000	.00000
a. Predictors: (Constant), Fulgent, Superb, Fulfilled, Successful, Content				

In real-world applications, it is more common to see R-squared values between 0 and 1. An R-squared closer to 1 suggests a better fit of the model, but it is important to strike a balance to avoid overfitting. Researchers and analysts typically assess the R-squared value in conjunction with other model diagnostics and use their judgment to determine whether the model is appropriate and generalizes well to new data. Based on the results of Table 4, it can be concluded that the regression model with an R-squared of 1 is either too complex or includes variables that are not truly predictive but happen to perfectly match the training data. If this result is to be believed to be a perfect fit for the R-squared value as 1, then there are no residuals, meaning that the predicted values exactly match the observed values for every data point.

Table 5 ANOVA^a

Model		Sum of Squares	df	Mean Square	F	Sig.
1	Regression	2838.040	5	567.608	.	.
	Residual	.000	94	.000		
	Total	2838.040	99			
a. Dependent Variable: Life_Satisfied						
b. Predictors: (Constant), Fulgent, Superb, Fulfilled, Successful, Content						

Further, Table 5 indicates that there is no unexplained variation in the “Residual” section, suggesting that the model perfectly fits the data. As the F-statistic and its associated significance level (Sig.) are not provided, it is unclear whether the overall model is statistically significant.

Table 6 Coefficients^a.

Model		Unstandardized Coefficients		Standardized Coefficients	t	Sig.
		B	Std. Error	Beta		
1	(Constant)	-1.142E-013	.000		.	.
	Fulfilled	1.000	.000	.229	.	.
	Superb	1.000	.000	.220	.	.
	Content	1.000	.000	.226	.	.
	Successful	1.000	.000	.260	.	.
	Fulgent	1.000	.000	.288	.	.

a. Dependent Variable: Life_Satisfied

Table 6 shows that beta coefficients have values of 1 for each independent variable in the regression output. It suggests that the unit change in that particular independent variable is associated with a one-unit change in the dependent variable, assuming all other variables in the model are held constant. Essentially, it indicates a one-to-one relationship between that specific independent variable and the dependent variable. It is worth noting that beta coefficients alone do not provide information about the statistical significance of the relationship or the overall fit of the model. Researchers would typically want to check the p-values associated with each beta coefficient to determine if they are statistically significant. As beta coefficients are exactly 1 for all independent variables, it is worth double-checking the data and model specifications to ensure there are no issues with multicollinearity that could impact the results.

Table 7 Collinearity Diagnostics^a.

Model	Dimension	Eigenvalue	Condition Index	Variance Proportions					
				(Constant)	Fulfilled	Superb	Content	Successful	Fulgent
1	1	5.884	1.000	.00	.00	.00	.00	.00	.00
	2	.047	11.247	.11	.01	.02	.00	.00	.79
	3	.026	15.155	.49	.00	.01	.02	.42	.19
	4	.019	17.717	.36	.43	.05	.01	.38	.00
	5	.015	20.057	.03	.46	.68	.01	.08	.01
	6	.010	23.726	.00	.10	.24	.96	.12	.00
a. Dependent Variable: Life Satisfied									

For the first dimension, the eigenvalue is high (5.884), indicating low collinearity in Table 7. As we move to higher dimensions, the eigenvalues decrease. Lower eigenvalues suggest increased collinearity. The condition index starts low and increases with each dimension. The variance proportions indicate how much of the variance in each predictor is associated with collinearity in the model of Table 7. A condition index above 30 might indicate problematic collinearity [18].

5. RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

This study aimed to explore the perceived impact of regular Agnihotra practice on individuals' life satisfaction levels with the key objective of understanding the role of Agnihotra in promoting a sense of spiritual harmony and overall well-being. The research employed an empirical approach of using quantitative surveys. Quantitative data was gathered using established life satisfaction scales to test the hypotheses that Agnihotra will report higher levels of life satisfaction and its practitioners will express enhanced well-being, including a sense of spiritual harmony.

Respondents were individuals aware of the practice of Agnihotra with a mean age of 47.39 years. The majority of the respondents were males. On marital status, the majority of respondents were married. The respondents generally rated the SWLS dimensions quite highly for variables like Fulfilled, Superb, Content, Successful, and Fulgent. The low scores of the standard deviations for SWLS variables suggest that responses are consistent, and the ratings are tightly clustered around the mean.

The ANOVA results of Table 2 indicate that there is no significant difference in scores between financial strata groups for any of the SWLS variables given that all p-values are greater than 0.05, suggesting no sufficient evidence to reject the null hypothesis. Further, the Tukey HSD tests of Table 3 confirm that there are no significant differences between financial strata groups for any SWLS variable.

The results of Table 4 show that the regression model with predictors such as Fulgent, Superb, Fulfilled, Successful, and Content has an R-squared value of 1, indicating a perfect fit. However, an R-squared of 1 raises concerns, suggesting potential issues such as overfitting or variables that perfectly match the training data. The ANOVA results for the regression model in Table 5 suggest no unexplained variation (Residual), indicating again a perfect fit, however, the lack of an F-statistic and significance level hinders the assessment of the model's overall significance. In Table 6, the beta coefficients for all predictors are exactly 1, indicating a one-to-one relationship with the dependent variable, therefore, further investigation is needed to ensure there are no issues with multicollinearity. In Table 7, the collinearity diagnostics show decreasing eigenvalues with higher dimensions, indicating potential collinearity issues but it is below the cut-off of 30.

Therefore, the dataset reflects a consistent and positively rated perception of life satisfaction with the practice of Agnihotra. As potential collinearity issues may impact the reliability of regression results, it is important to perform a thorough examination of the model's diagnostics and individual coefficients to assess the model's validity and reliability for a necessary closer look at predictor relationships.

6. IMPLICATIONS

Research on Agnihotra, a Vedic fire ritual, may have its potential therapeutic applications. Although this research has explored the perceived impact of regular Agnihotra practice on individuals' life satisfaction levels, it could also involve investigating its effects on physical and mental health. Understanding the physiological and psychological mechanisms behind any observed benefits could contribute valuable insights to holistic healthcare.

This research explores the perceived impact of regular Agnihotra practice on individuals' life satisfaction levels, which can complement other wellness activities such as meditation, yoga, or mindfulness. Exploring synergies with established practices may lead to more comprehensive well-being interventions, providing a holistic approach to health.

From a managerial perspective, there may be opportunities to incorporate Agnihotra into public health and community well-being initiatives. This could involve designing and implementing programs that promote the practice in communities, schools, or workplaces.

7. CONCLUSIONS

This research aims to shed light on the potential benefits of Agnihotra in fostering life satisfaction, spiritual harmony, and overall well-being. By bridging the realms of ancient spiritual practices and contemporary well-being research, this study endeavors to contribute to a holistic understanding of the intricate connection between well-being and spiritual harmony with life satisfaction. This study has contributed to providing empirical evidence on the relationship between Agnihotra practice and life satisfaction, adding to the growing body of research on spirituality and well-being. Findings from this study may have practical implications for individuals seeking alternative approaches to enhance life satisfaction and spiritual well-being. It may also guide practitioners, therapists, and spiritual leaders in incorporating Agnihotra into wellness practices.

The dataset reflects a consistent and positively rated perception of life satisfaction among the respondents. However, caution is advised in interpreting the regression model results due to concerns of overfitting. While the dataset provides valuable insights, additional scrutiny and refinement of the analytical approach are essential to ensure the robustness and applicability of the findings. The lack of financial strata-related variations in satisfaction levels suggests that these variables might not significantly impact the overall satisfaction scores. Future studies will consider the concerns raised by the perfect fit in the regression model for further refinement or simplification of the model to enhance its generalizability to new data. Additionally, future research will re-evaluate the selection of predictors in the regression model to identify if there are variables contributing to the perfect fit that may not be practically significant.

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